VELVET COCONUT / PENNED PICTURES / GINGA STORIES · STORYBOARD

OFFSET

After years caring for her dying mother, a grieving woman tags along with a fling and his wealthy friends to a five-day retreat, hoping to finally put herself out there and live. The retreat is built around a device that grants shared access to each guest's deepest fantasy, until she turns it, one twist at a time, into an instrument of reckoning.

58 scenes 300 shots Written and directed by Thomas David Beatty Ungers House II, Villa Glashuette

ACT I Arrival ACT IIA Immersion and Erosion ACT IIB The Hunt and the Outhouse ACT III The Reckoning

The film in frames

Every shot in order, start to finish. The coloured edge on each panel marks its world.

Eve nightmare · Reality · Fantasy · Memory: grey · Memory: good times · Memory: walk to the cinema · Night · Party · The hunt · Device / infinity · Walking out

Visual rules

From the Director's Statement, Deck V5 and the Miro board.

REALITY
Black-and-white Ungers architecture. Centred, symmetrical, locked-off wides. The house dominates the frame.

NEON GREEN
The only saturated colour in the real world: device rings, cameras, bottled water, the outhouse door. Under for longer, the rings drift to yellow, then red.

FANTASY
Warm, syrupy yellow light, slowed time, a floating camera. Each guest's desire gets its own world.

MEMORY
Mother's flat, handheld and close. Greyish for the hard years, growing harsher as the fantasies grow vivid. White and bright when she reflects on the good times. Warm yellow for the walk to the cinema.

BOARD GRADE
House scenes carry a slight green cast. Fantasies glow warm yellow. Red for the dancing, the sex scenes and the final fantasies turning to nightmares (not Eleanora's). Flashbacks are washed white.

PROGRESSION
Controlled and objective in Act One, subjective and immersive by Act Three. Rooms feel smaller. The feast rots.

SOUND
TWIST then CLICK marks every passage under, louder each time. Rooms go quiet; breath gets heavier.

Cast

Character portraits from Deck V5.

Eleanora
Spanish. Cared for her mother through a long illness; now grieving, and putting herself out there to experience life.
Desire: Pain-free time with her mother, well again.

Ezra
Eleanora's fling. An actor, charming in public, corrosive in private.
Desire: Continuous admiration.

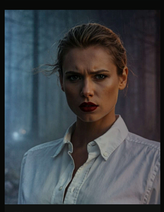
Cali
Lifelong eating disorder, masked by a free-spirit act.
Desire: Unlimited chocolate cake and a mirror that never changes.

Cai
Countercultural, escapist, quick to close ranks.
Desire: Undefined. Escape.

Jacqueline
Multilingual, razor-sharp, performing 'dumb' for Jasper.
Desire: A family, including pregnancy.

Jasper
Generational wealth, charm over manipulation.
Desire: Psychological and sexual dominance.

Charlie
The showman who built the house and the device.
Desire: Redemption through creation.



Flo
Danish socialite ruled by order and correction.
Desire: An endless cycle of restoring order.

Frans
Danish entrepreneur. Hunter. Knew about Eve.
Desire: Human hunting with full agency.

The device

A neural implant on trial. Anchored at the base of the skull where the spine meets the brainstem, a slender surgical spike reaches the cortex. It does not just read signals; it rewrites them. To the user the fantasy is indistinguishable from reality.

SIZE	About 1 inch across, raised about 0.4 from the skin
FORM	Circular, white, smooth; slightly convex, like a magnifying glass
OPERATE	Twist the dial once per hour, then push the middle
OUTER RING	Green when the device is on
INNER RING	Green when connected to a subject
TIME UNDER	The longer in the fantasy, the further it glows toward red

BRIGHT GREEN Connected

BRIGHT YELLOW Hours under

BRIGHT RED Infinity / Eve

Arrival

01 BLACK / INT. EVE'S FANTASY – STAIRWELL – NIGHT

BLACK. A woman spirals up a stairwell in slow motion while Mother and Eleanora's voices tell her this is not real. At the top, the open balcony beckons with warm yellow light. She jumps at it with all her might.

1.1
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot

1.2
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot, Looking Up

1.3
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot, Looking Down

1.4
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot

BLACK. Then her muddled feet pound the steps, leaving dark smears behind. Her breath echoes loudly.

MOTHER (V.O.) Wake up, Eleanora. Wake up! Eleanora.

A WOMAN spirals up the stairwell in slow motion.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Eleanora, Eleanora. Evie is no real. MOTHER (V.O.) This is not her.

She hurls at the top of the stairs, frozen in place. Her eyes dart back to where she came from. Her footprints are still there, dark and real. Panic through the stairs, and dressing gown.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Um no? The ass tongs just material. Is a it. A it remove ass she who... This just you no fiction in stone.

She spirals again.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Put mouths eye interstates serendipitously to conquistadors.

She jumps at it with all her might.

JUMP CUT TO:

1.5
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot

1.6
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Insert, Knee

1.7
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Insert, Foot

The opening. It with warm yellow light, beckoning her in.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Pea's vampire. Forwan.

She jumps at it with all her might.

JUMP CUT TO:

1.8
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot

1.9
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot

1.10
Int. Eve's Fantasy – Stairwell – Night
Wide Shot

Turning the corner, she sees the open balcony.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Is knee pseudo mirac ass sonnetes, perci panda pseda cupitur to pupi egoTrica hatiar on mi tongue.

She evades shaky, fear grips her.

ELEANORA (V.O.) No you need to stay silent.

02 INT. TAXI – MORNING (MOVING)

Eleanora jolts awake against the sun window. Fix brushes off her questions, the driver says they have been crossing the border at this one. She draws a circle on the window, then its centre.

2.1
Int. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.2
Int. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Closeup, Eleanora

2.3
Int. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Insert, Window

SOURCE: Script p.1
WORLD: ■ Reality
LOOK: Eleanora dormitastic: overtired, tucked off, wide. Winter coat against black hood.

Two large black taxis move down country lanes.

Flat morning countryside whizzes by.

The time is 13:00 on the car clock.

2.4
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.5
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.6
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.7
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.8
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.9
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.10
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.11
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.12
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.13
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

2.14
Ext. Taxi – Morning (Moving)
Wide Shot

Immersion and Erosion

12 INT. CALI'S FANTASY - LIVING ROOM / KITCHEN - NIGHT

Cali's fantasy of a perfect life with Jacqueline, a cozy home filled with warmth and comfort. The illusion is shown as a dream.

13 INT. CALI'S FANTASY - BEDROOM - NIGHT (CALI'S CONFESSION)

Cali's fantasy continues with intimate, tender moments. She confesses her love to Jacqueline, expressing her deepest desires.

14 INT. JACQUELINE'S FANTASY - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Jacqueline's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

15 FLASHBACK - INT. MOTHER'S FLAT - BATHROOM - DAY

Flashback of childhood, where the mother and Cali bathe. Shows the complex relationship between them.

16 INT. JACQUELINE'S FANTASY - BATHROOM / INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Jacqueline's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

17 INT. RETREAT - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

18 EXT. RETREAT - NIGHT (CESS ARRIVES)

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

19 INT. ENTRANCE HALL - NIGHT

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

20 INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

21 INT. BEDROOM - MORNING

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

22 INT. RETREAT - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

23 INT. LIVING ROOM - BALCONY DOOR - DAY

Flashback to Cali and Jacqueline's first time at the retreat, a moment of passion and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

24 INT. ELEANOR'S FANTASY - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

25 EXT. RETREAT - CLEARING

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

26 EXT. FOREST CLEARING - CAT'S FANTASY (INTERCUT MOTHER'S FLAT)

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

27 INT. CAT'S FANTASY - BATHROOM / BLACK WATER

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

28 INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

29 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK / FLASHBACK)

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

30 INT. BEDROOM - MORNING

A morning scene with Lauren. The day's grief looms, though Eleanor tries with a cheerful mask.

31 INT. LIVING ROOM - MORNING

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

32 INT. BEDROOM - DAY

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

33 INT. ELEANOR'S FANTASY - BEDROOM / DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

34 INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY (CESS'S STORY) / JASPER'S FANTASY

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

35 INT. EXIT: KIRAN'S FANTASY - IMAGOE / FOREST - DAY

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

36 INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

37 EXT. FLAT'S FANTASY - LAKE EDGE - DAY

Eleanor's fantasy of a perfect life with Cali, a moment of vulnerability and connection. The illusion is shown as a dream.

The Hunt and the Outhouse

Scenes: 54 to 61

38 EXT. FRONT ENTRANCE - NIGHT

We do not hear what is being said. Evil Dora is very animated with his speech and apologia while Eleanora stands and smokes.

SOUND: Script and
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Wide, Archetype Hand.

39 INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Elora is tied with Eleanora. She finishes him off without a word, staring at the ceiling, then smears his release across his palate.

SOUND: Script and
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Static, unflinching.

Ezra is bed with Eleanora. She looks increasingly upset the closer he gets to climaxing. Again she finishes him off without saying a word, still staring at the ceiling, a vacant look across her eyes.

ECHA: She does it. You really stand it, don't you? Get me some water.

She sits at the side of the bed, he rolls over.

Her hand covered, she walks over to his jacket and smears his release onto it, using the front of her hand and the back.

40 INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanora hears a scuffle. Flares sits in the dark at the back of the dining room behind the rotting food, eating.

SOUND: Script par 40
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Dim room with light on his back.

Eleanora hears a rustle and goes into the dining room. A figure sits at the head of the room, behind the rotting food. Flares, but a little light hitting the side of his body, reasons he's visible. She pauses and stares briefly at him.

The noise of him eating increases.

Flares sits behind the rotting food, eating in the dark.

The noise of him eating increases.

The rotting food between them; Flares keeps eating, unbothered.

41 INT. HALLWAY / BEDROOM - NIGHT

Elora is asleep. Through blurred vision a figure darts down the corridor, toy chests down Elora's back. Eleanora follows the woman, removing every step. When they meet, they are blurred. they slow dances through every empty room.

SOUND: Script par 41
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Blurred - Ensemble Steadicam through the house.

Eleanora walks down two glasses of water. Ezra is sitting on the bed, his back to the doorway. Without a word, a figure darts down the corridor. Startled, she turns to Ezra, his cowards down his back. From the top of his neck to the base of his spine.

The toy chests as from, the hope of his neck down to the base of his spine.

Eleanora rises and follows the unknown woman. They dance through the house, moving as one. Before entering the attic, Ezra trying to escape the property.

When they finally meet, they are dressed identically. They look deeply into each other. They push their bodies together, intimate.

42 INT. BEDROOM - MORNING

The ring proves, Eleanora opens her eyes quickly opens, places a hand on the back of her neck and a wave of calm washes over her.

SOUND: Script par 42
MUSIC: Nanny
LOOK: Soft morning, smoky dust.

Moving at once, Eleanora opens her eyes to empty noise. She sticks a hand on the back of her neck and shoots deeply a wave of calm washes over her again.

EXT. FOREST - DAY - ELEANORA'S FANTASY. She walks through the forest, she stops and looks around, some of the things she sees.

Her old driving scent is now outside in the forest an enchanted, dreamy, a pull of fear on a small table among the scents.

43 INT. KITCHEN - DAY (OISU WASHING)

Eleanora does the dishes while Jasper and Fiona watch. Fiona splashes him. Ezra calls her a creepy fan who doesn't listen; she says all he has ever been with is liars. To test you were going to strike a good flash.

SOUND: Script par 43
MUSIC: Nanny
LOOK: Classic Crit that becomes Hamilton as it escalates.

Eleanora starts doing the dishes, Jasper is lounging in the background with Fiona, we see them over her shoulder. Fiona throws more dishes in the sink which splashes up some Eleanora.

ELEANORA: Oh yeah. This is my school. The Principal, ELEANORA, needs to see Jasper. ELEANORA is an old friend of mine. ELEANORA is very close friend. ELEANORA does not like liars or scam men. Jasper, I'll make this tough. BUT I

From walls off and Eleanora. The argument escalates.

ECHA: It's a house you come across like a bit of a fan now. I find it creepy. ELEANORA: But it's a creepy house. ECHA: I'm not saying it's not. I'm saying I find it creepy. ELEANORA: Well, I'm sorry you're unhappy. And I'm sorry you're ghetto. And because I'm not, it freaks you out. ECHA: I'm not ghetto. I'm from Bel Air.

Ezra, unimpressed.

FIONA: Cause you're a little just. ELEANORA: And you're a twat.

44 EXT. RETREAT - NIGHT (INTERCUT GROUP)

Eleanora smokes outside, a spring snow has settled for the rooftops near. It's 10 green. Immoral: the group doesn't like rudeness and her mother's death. A TWIST and CLICK echoes.

SOUND: Script pty 19
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Green Steel Warm Interior

The house from across the water as night falls, its windows lit.

Eleanora is outside hearing a smoke and enjoying away a cigarette. Jasper appeared an can see the outhouse door lit with glows.

INTERCUT WITH THE GROUP.

ECHA: Well, you know what I think, you have no idea... CON: Well, we. Brain scrub out of her. SHOTS her out of our family. FRIEND her group. NOOSE of a TWIST and CLICK echoes.

45 INT. JACQUELINE'S FANTASY - NIGHT

Eleanora holds Jacqueline's hand as she screams in pain.

SOUND: Script pty
MUSIC: Fantasy
LOOK: Dusky, haunt.

Eleanora holds Jacqueline's hand as she screams in pain.

JACQUELINE: Did I know where this is going to go? ELEANORA: Did I see you choose?

Eleanora holds Jacqueline's face gently, the two close in for a yellow light.

ELEANORA: Did I know?

46 EXT. RETREAT - NIGHT / INT. HOUSE

Smoking with Eleanora, Jasper tells her he's a fan actual since. She talks about Jasper, his fantasy, children she cannot have. Eleanora, she groaned her mother before she died. It have it to becoming a ghost and you can't stop her.

Jacqueline smoking with Eleanora. She has a shift in tone and temperament. Eleanora knows the supernatural is present.

JACQUELINE: Oh yeah. This is my school. And. The Principal, which Jasper contacted you... ELEANORA: I'm not going to the party. JACQUELINE: That's not me. It's been a crisis since, and it's literally a normal regime... It makes him laugh. Isn't it?

Ezra kisses laughing with Jasper in the background. INTERCUT: flashes of Jasper's homes.

JACQUELINE: I don't want to see his fantasy to see what he wants. I'm not going to be a part of that. I'm not. I'm not. I'm here for me. Long... JACQUELINE: I don't want to be a part of his fantasy, a ghost and you're searching for me. ... Can you stop here, entirely for?

Laughter.

Elora, laughing, and Ivan over his eyes, hand at his mouth.

Laughter.

Wide, then Eleanor closing Ivan eyes.

47 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (THE LAST NIGHT)

Ezra and Jasper start any sorts of themselves in front of the group. Eleanora is eyes search the room for reassurance, the women avoid her gaze, each wearing the same sand dread.

ECHA: It's a house night, sort of themselves in front of the group. Eleanora is eyes search the room for reassurance, the women avoid her gaze, each wearing the same sand dread.

Ezra and Jasper start any sorts of themselves in front of the group. Eleanora is eyes search the room for reassurance, the women avoid her gaze, each wearing the same sand dread.

Jacqueline is terrified by a figure from the dark, Fiona's hunting gear looks up into the dark.

Eleanora watches the house and tries the locked door. Fiona's hunting gear looks up into the dark, the other women are locked as well.

We can hear breathing surrounding her.

Eleanora returns to the house and tries the locked door. Fiona's hunting gear looks around the house, the other women are locked as well.

We can hear breathing surrounding her.

Ezra's voice, sparring not damaged by prolonged 'infinity' use.

Gearing for an ASSHOLES CUT TO

Fear trying to go, she desperately looks up to the window above. She scanned she danced through the house with vase down at the.

Gearing for an ASSHOLES CUT TO

48 EXT. FRANK'S FANTASY - FOREST - NIGHT (THE HUNT)

Eleanora awakes in the house floor, hands bound, a brown eyed woman sprints past. She grasps one hundred between the trees. Jacqueline is spotted. Eleanora reaches the house, finds every door locked, and is greeted and chased again by the.

EXT. FRANK'S FANTASY - FOREST - NIGHT. Eleanora awakes in the house floor, hands bound, a brown eyed woman sprints past. She grasps one hundred between the trees. Jacqueline is spotted. Eleanora reaches the house, finds every door locked, and is greeted and chased again by the.

Her hand stares at the dirt floor of the forest as she wakes up.

Coughing.

Eleanora sprints, hitting branches, cutting her face.

Branches snapping.

A blood-soaked woman sprints past her, her exoskeleton frantic, unnatural.

RED: ELEANORA'S MOTHER. JACQUELINE / DAT PRINCIPAL PHOTO.

Another figure flees between the trees.

We hear other voices ELEANORA OR PHOTO.

Eleanora hears rustles through the trees and sees some of the group running between them.

Rustling, running feet.

Eleanora runs into a clearing.

A tone figure stands in the light between the trees. In the distance another person is hunted down.

We hear other voices ELEANORA OR PHOTO.

The hand lightens around her throat.

Silence.

Then she opens them.

49 INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT (RED TIME)

Bed time. Ezra ties far away from Eleanora. Ti think everyone should experience everything.

Ezra ties far away from Eleanora. She stares through the dark doorway.

ECHA: I think everyone should experience everything.

50 EXT. / INT. OUTHOUSE - THE OFFSET LAB - NIGHT

Fully alienated, Eleanora realises a light time to try the outhouse. She discovers it ive. hushed to being machinery. Ive doctor operating on her, damaged by prolonged 'infinity' use.

Eleanora makes a night time trip across the grounds toward the glow of the outhouse.

Distant breathing.

Candles burn low, their flames bending toward the vortex floor. The glow rises, mixing the mood. It hum is particularly long.

Laughing, reading not glimpse of water.

The door stands ajar, its frame glowing neon green.

A low hum.

Inside the outhouse: mattress, beds, the lab.

Eleanora makes a night time trip across the grounds toward the glow of the outhouse.

Distant breathing.

Eleanora's eyes take it in many devices, all glowing green, pulsing, reflected in her pupils.

Laughing, reading not glimpse of water.

Ezra's scientific, sparring not damaged by prolonged 'infinity' use.

Gearing for an ASSHOLES CUT TO

Cole grabs Eleanora's arm to stop her, then pauses, a look of realisation washes over her face. She lets go apologetically.

51 INT. HOUSE - STAIRS / LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanora shuts down the equipment and hauls Eva into the house to confront the group. Charlie and Cole's culpability is asserted. Eva, grinning and in agony, begs to be killed as acts of Eleanora's mother.

SOUND: Script par 51
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Horror regime. The color stain surrounds, now real.

Eleanora shuts down the equipment and hauls Eva into the house to confront the group.

Unheard breathing.

INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT. Eleanora, out of breath but trying to remain silent, listens for any sight and stops her against a the cold of the staircase.

Unheard breathing.

INTERCUT BETWEEN BEDROOMS. Eleanora enters all the bedrooms and whispers to everyone.

Whispers.

FLASHBACK FROM THE YEAR BEFORE. We come across a few of their phone clothes, devices on, laughing and giving.

CHECK We must name this one Dora.

Eleanora opens her eyes. Eva slowly walks towards her, struggling to find balance, and grabs onto her. Eleanora, now in her eyes, looks more concerned for Eva than for herself.

52 INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanora and Cole have words just from the backstory during in the same spot as the year before.

SOUND: Script par 52
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Watches the cold open's loop.

FLASHBACK - EXT. MOTHER'S CUT - DAY. Eleanora holds her Mother's hand. She gives her mum a hug. They ring goes when lights.

Eva breaks free and jumps from the balcony, dying in the same spot as the year before.

53 INT. HOUSE - BALCONY - NIGHT

Eva breaks free and jumps from the balcony, dying in the same spot as the year before.

SOUND: Script pty2
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Watches the cold open's loop.

FLASHBACK - EXT. MOTHER'S CUT - DAY. Eleanora holds her Mother's hand. She gives her mum a hug. They ring goes when lights.

54 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (THE REQUEST)

The group fractures into Jamie, Jamie and dereal ("You thought she died?"). Eleanora quietly asks to go back into the decision tree more time.

SOUND: Script pty 54
MUSIC: Night
LOOK: Dawn, quiet.

The group scrambles to distance themselves, fracturing into Jamie, Jamie and dereal.

CHARLIE: You thought she died? Was that going to be your reply?

Eleanora's quiet, unsettling request.

ELEANORA: One more time.

ACT III

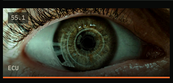
The Reckoning

Scenes 55 to 58

55 INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT (THE RECKONING)

One final shared session at the ruined feast table. One by one, Eleanora turns each device past its intended duration toward 'infinity': Frans first, a physical struggle she wins; then Charlie, turned by a weeping, complicit Coco; then the rest.

SOURCE Script p94-95
WORLD Device / infinity
LOOK Centred and controlled again, but now Eleanora holds the dial. Device moves from green to orange-red.



STATIC

Reluctantly, grief-numbed and eager to move past what just happened, the group agrees to one final shared session at the ruined feast table. Eleanora turns a device past its intended duration, toward 'infinity'.

TWIST. TWIST. TWIST.

STATIC

Frans slowly leans forward to see if she is in the system. He moves her hair off her neck and catches a glance of the device with just one green circle.

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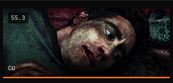

HANDHELD

Frans first: a physical struggle she wins.

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STATIC

Charlie, filled with rage, moves to attack her and shouts; Coco comes to comfort him. Then Charlie is turned by a weeping, complicit Coco; then the rest of the group in sequence.

CHARLIE (shouting, unheard)

56 INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT (THE FIGHT)

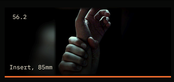
Ezra is the final and hardest confrontation: a full physical fight across the spoiled feast. Eleanora narrowly overpowers him.

SOURCE Script p95-96
WORLD Device / infinity
LOOK Handheld, close, brutal.

HANDHELD

Ezra snaps and lunges. He climbs onto the table and crawls across it like a maniac as the others pull back.

Glasses topple.



HANDHELD

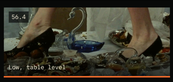
Eleanora meets him head on. He seizes her wrist; the table shakes as they each try to gain the upper hand.

.

HANDHELD

Ezra, blood smeared down his neck and shirt, comes at her again.

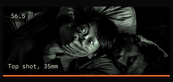
.



HANDHELD

Ezra pushes Eleanora across the table and into the decaying food; plates and glasses scatter as they struggle across it.

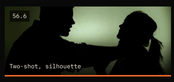
Glass breaking.



HANDHELD

They find themselves at the end of the table. Ezra pins her down, his hand clamped over her mouth; her eyes wide.

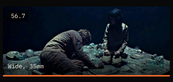
Muffled breathing.



HANDHELD

Ezra is choking her. Eleanora scratches his face, making him wince; he tightens his grip just before she is about to pass out.

CLICK.



STATIC

She swings around and hits his device. Ezra collapses forward across the table; Eleanora kneels among the plates, gasping, collecting air.

Heavy breathing.

STATIC

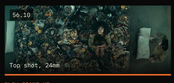
Ezra lies across the table amid the ruined feast, eyes open, staring at nothing as he slips into the system.

.

PUSH IN

She twists his device even further, just before infinity. Eleanora moves around the table doing it to each person.

ELEANORA (V.O) My Mother knew what she meant to me.



SLOW CRANE UP

Eleanora sits amid the ruined feast, the group slumped around the table in the system, one by one.

.

STATIC

Eleanora stands, spattered with the rotten food, surveying what she has done.

Silence; the hum of the devices.

STATIC

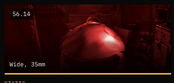
INTERCUT: Eleanora has a hot shower and cleans off the rotten food.

Water running.

STATIC

Coco checking the group's vitals as they are in the system.

Monitors beeping.



STATIC

INTERCUT: A morbidly obese Cali, in pain, hunched over the table.

ELEANORA (V.O) A year for a year.

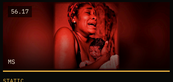
STATIC

She stuffs cake into her mouth. Her mirror unchanged.

HANDHELD

Hands gripping and scratching Jasper from bodies unseen.

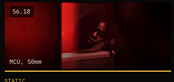
ELEANORA (V.O) They lived reckless and careless lives and forgot about her.



STATIC

Jacqueline cries against a bed as a baby cries on it.

ELEANORA (V.O) So they will stay in there. Like she did.



STATIC

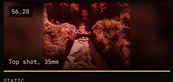
Jacqueline slumped over the edge of the bath, spent, in the red light.

.

STATIC

Flo's fingers bleed, fumbling as she tries to conceal the marks on the glass.

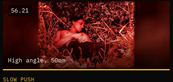
ELEANORA (V.O) What is desire if it's fulfilled?



STATIC

Cal lies on the grass, overdosing, consumed by the drugs: sunk into the earth, arms spread, the ground closing over him.

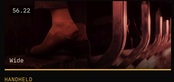
ELEANORA (V.O) What is thirst when it's quenched?



SLOW PUSH

His eyes close; the undergrowth swallows him.

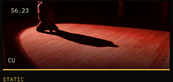
.



HANDHELD

Charlie gives tours in agony, attempting to bask in glory, but his trembling legs and blistered feet barely hold him up.

ELEANORA (V.O) It's nothing. Nothing comes from nothing.



STATIC

Ezra's make-up streaks from tears as he and the fans are in agony, but they continue clapping.

ELEANORA (V.O) And after all the pleasure and gorging and idolising. The question still stands.

57 INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY - MOTHER - (FINAL)

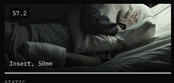
A flicker of hesitation as her hand lifts toward her neck. FLASHBACK to her fantasy with her Mother, as before: she leans in on her Mother at the table. 'No eres mi madre.'

SOURCE Script p97
WORLD Fantasy
LOOK Fantasy yellow: a flashback to her earlier fantasy, not a return.

STATIC

FLASHBACK: Eleanora with her Mother in her earlier fantasy, remembered, not revisited.

.



STATIC

FLASHBACK - INT. MOTHER'S FLAT. Eleanora holds the pillow above her mum's head and presses down a little. Then she releases it to the floor.

.

STATIC

She gives her mum a huge hug. They grip each other tightly.

.

STATIC

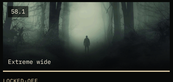
INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY - NIGHT. She leans in on her Mother, close, the two resting against each other.

ELEANORA No eres mi madre. (You are not my Mother.)

58 EXT. RETREAT - DAY / LATER: INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Eleanora walks barefoot down the lane, away from the house, alive and entirely alone. Later, the group lie dusty and wired in, kept in the system.

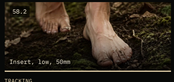
SOURCE Script p97
WORLD Walking out
LOOK Extreme wide, still, fog.



LOCKED-OFF

Eleanora walks barefoot down the lane away from the house, alive and entirely alone.

.



TRACKING

Under her bare feet, the ground is damp with dew; each step soft but deliberate.

ELEANORA (V.O) Would your fantasy really be your fantasy if you could have it all the time?

STATIC

LATER: dust hangs in the light of the living room.

.

SLOW TRACK

The group lie in rows, wired in, feeding tubes and lines running from each of them: kept in the system, indefinitely.

The hum of the machines.

SLOW TRACK

LATER: INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY. The group are all slightly dusty, connected to devices, feeding tubes, heart monitors and IVs.

ELEANORA (V.O) Or should it always be just out of reach. Aimed for but never grasped.

STATIC

Heart monitors tick over beside each of them, keeping the group suspended in the system.

The steady beep of the monitors. ELEANORA (V.O) Forever. Para siempre. FADE TO BLACK.

Would your fantasy really be your fantasy...
if you could have it all the time?

Or should it always be... just out of reach.
Aimed for... but never grasped.

Not to run... or to fly.
But to walk... with my voice.

Forever...
Para siempre.